

The basic cryptographic discovery that I've made is a simple substitution code that I've been calling "Shadow Morse". We know that Sanborn has said that one of his artistic themes is light and shadow, and the word SHADOW is right there in the Morse.

To form Shadow Morse, simply change every dit to a dah, and every dah to a dit. This forms the table in the upper right hand corner of my worksheet. Since correspondences are two-way or reflective, I only wrote each letter once rather than writing the complete alphabet in the left column.

Next, convert every K0 Morse segment into its corresponding shadow equivalent. Sanborn has made statements that the alignment or orientation of certain letters in Kryptos is important and this is true of the Morse just as much as it is of the courtyard sculpture. Since 5 of the 7 segments consist of 2 lines of Morse and some Morse letters are longer than others, writing these out on graph paper or in a monospace font gives an inadequate representation of those alignments. I did make some attempt on my worksheet to indicate those alignments, but it does a pretty crappy job of it. I'd urge you to look at Jim Gillogly's pics of the Morse (or any other pics of it that you have) to get a better view of those alignments.

I believe that the shadow morse translation contains many references to the courtyard sculpture. Some of these ideas are speculative, but I'll lay out what I believe I've identified.

SOS : I believe that OSO is a reference to the visual nature of the courtyard sculpture when viewed from above. One of the themes of Kryptos is the progression of cryptography from linear, 1D codes (such as Morse), to 2D codes such as Vigenere or Quagmire, to (perhaps?) spatial forms of encoding. So, traveling into the 3rd dimension to get a view of Kryptos from above, we can see that the copperplate forms an S and the pool beneath the tableau side is one of the O's. (Since making this observation, I've wondered if there's anything in particular in the corresponding area bounded by the CT side. Did you notice anything there when you visited the courtyard?)

RQ: Several of the shadow morse sequences refer to specific lines of the copperplate, I believe. KF in this case seems to refer to the 10th line of the CT side, which ends in KF. The PT of this line contains the reference to WW, and I believe this is a major hint to focus on doubled letters as we work through the steps of solving K4. (I have other evidence supporting this belief which I'll keep under my hat for now.)

LUCIDEEE

MEMORYE: The shadow morse equivalent of LUCIDEEE doesn't have any meaning that I've been able to discover, but the untranslated reading of it definitely does. More on that later. In addition, I believe there are some stego messages found by reading the engraved dits and dahs (not the shadow dits and dahs) of LUCID (dropping the 3 "spacer" E's) in reverse, or from east to west. My friend Eric Harshbarger once created a puzzle based on non-delimited morse and wrote an app to help solve such sequences (<http://www.ericharshbarger.org/epp/2010/unmorser.html>), so that helped in finding these messages, since non-delimited morse can be parsed in a huge number of ways. One of the messages I believe was intended is EAST WEST E. There's one more that I won't disclose for now, and there may be others that I haven't noticed yet. BTW, on the subject of those "spacer" E's, I believe I have some idea of the significance of most of those. This has probably been noted by some folks in the Kryptos Group before, so I can't claim it as my own discovery. For this morse segment, I believe the 3 dots after LUCID and the 1 dot after MEMORY refer to the 31 columns of the tableau side and of Jim's worksheets and the fact that all of the lines of K4 on the sculpture have 31 characters, unlike the varying numbers of characters per line in all the other sections.

T IS YOUR

POSITION: My worksheet doesn't do an adequate job of capturing the alignment of these letters, but I believe they form a "word picture" that roughly translates to "X some KGB moles". In addition, interpreting the T IS YOUR line (as engraved, not the shadowed version) as a non-delimited string from east to west can produce the message END MORSE T, which I believe is another stego message.

DIG(E)TALEEE

INTERPRETATIT: I believe this is a reference to another specific line in the CT, this one being the 4th line of K3.

I believe this line, in conjunction with other information and discoveries, leads to the key that gets us through the first doorway to the solution to K4. I think the second line is another sort of "word picture" that I'd interpret as symbolizing the Cold War. The K(ryptos) team is pulling in one direction, while the K-T(eam) enemy is pulling in the other. In support of that reading, I'd note that the two halves of this shadow string read in opposite directions and the unshadowed equivalent of K is R. When you reflect an R, you get the Cyrillic letter YA, which certainly has been noted in the Kryptos Group before.

EEVIRTUALLY

EEEEEEINVISIBLE : The significant features of this one are the doubled letters (YY), and the 2 spacers/6 spacers referring to the 26 letters of the alphabet. Also, the fact that E INVISIBLE is a palindromic sequence has been noted before. Perhaps the shadow reading of this one is also Jim's way of saying "Hi MOM" (LOL).

EESHADOWEE

FORCESEEEEE: Note that the unshadowed morse reading of this one begins with the word SEE reading from east to west, and directly below that in the shadow reading we get a Q. I believe this is a reference to the ending of K3 "X can you see anything Q". With regard to the spacers, I interpret the 2 and the 5 as referring to a 5-digit binary number which can have a value up to 31, which we already know is a significant number. In addition, I just noted during the process of typing up these notes that FORCES contains a CES corresponding to the misspelling PALIMPCEST, so I applied that to the shadow translations of PALIMPCEST and ABSCISSA as shown. Since I just discovered that, I'll have to explore its significance as I try to make my way through further doorways.